ENTREPRENURSHIP IN

CUTTING, TAILORING AND DRESS MAKING

Clothing is one of the basic necessities of man. These days because of the occupational and domestic demands most of us cannot find time to stitch our clothes and depend on tailors or ready-made garments. Further people have become fashion conscious, which has lead to increased demand for well-designed clothes. There are ample opportunities for both wage and self-employment.

As **wage employment** you can work as manager, production assistant, pattern maker. cutter, supervisor, tailor, dress designer, finisher etc. Whereas even for **self-employment** one can look into various areas like tailor, finisher, boutique owner, manufacturer for garments, uniform maker on contract basis, organizer of hobby classes and many such related jobs for which sky is the limit. For doing all these kind of works you firstly require a very through knowledge of the subject and secondly, equally important you should know the proper steps for setting up a unit.

Qualities which as an entrepreneur you should possess or which you should develop for starting any business.

- ***Analyze your strengths and weakness***

  This will give you a fair idea of the skills that you have and about the skills that you need to polish. Try to analyse in which areas you are good.

- ***Ability to compete with the competitors***

  You should be aware about the latest trends and styles as well as the products which are available in the market.

- ***Listen to your customers and have patient ear***

  Always answer their queries correctly. Deal with each customer politely. Politeness can take you to the top, whereas harsh words may make your customer go away.

- ***Always give due stress or importance to the service and quality*** that you are providing. Since the competition is on the rise, every customer looks in for the service and quality that he/she is being provided for the money that he /she is paying for.

- Make sure that you ***display your products neatly and attractively***. A good display always catches the eye and impresses the customer.

- One must also ensure that the ***product meets the customers taste and requirement*** also. The product should be acceptable to the user as well as there should be professional touch in the work that you do.

If you set up your own establishment or enterprise, then you need to be familiar with the following:

- Why you want to start the particular enterprise or **why you want to step in i.e. the decision to be self employed**. This is the most important step, and for this one should be able to analyze ones own potential. You have to be very confident and realistic in your goal setting. There may be problems but if you are determined then no one can stop you from going ahead. Talk to some experienced people in this field make a visit to some of the well set units and share their experiences. All the places you may not get a very friendly response but do not worry and be determined. There fore to take final decision you need.

  Attitude /inclination towards a specific business.

  Educational /technical qualification, training undergone.

  Knowing his/ her capacity to mobilize the resource (Human and non- human)

- Next you have to do the selection of the area. i.e. **market survey**. Before setting up a unit it is important for an entrepreneur to undertake a very through market survey of the product line to be chosen.

  Consider the following factors in mind-

  Which product the people are using the most. Where there is more scope and requirement, whether its children wear or ladies wear or any other household product. What is the availability of labor, technical experts in this field.

❖ The next step is to decide upon the **size of the establishment** whether you want a small, medium or large unit, then work out the advantages and disadvantages of these 3 types of units, How big is the business? Can one person manage it? What kind of manpower is required? Answers to such questions and many more, helps to decide the type of the organization structure.

There are various types of organizational structure i.e.

- Partnership firm
- Co- operative society
- Company

For business having ***small size of operations***, the partnership or proprietary firm is better as it ensures direct control over business operations.

Proprietary Unit: In such a unit a single individual is the sole owner of the concern and conduct the business himself or herself, bearing the entire risk and deciding all policy matters individually.

Partnership firm: As per the Indian Partnership Act 1932, a partnership is the relation between persons who have agreed to share the profits of a business carried on by all or any of them acting for all. A partnership firm cannot have more than 20 people. A written agreement known as partnership deed is worked out. The firm has to be registered on a prescribed format with the registrar of firms, along with prescribed fees and relevant papers

❖ **Selection of Location and site**: For a successful project or a business, a suitable site is a very important factor and its decision is based upon several considerations. Therefore advance planning is required and for which certain factors have to be kept in mind i.e....

Proximity to the market and access to raw material: This is very important, as there is always an easy availability of the raw material, money spend on the transportation for getting the raw material is saved, situations of emergency can be handled easily, therefore panic and stress levels are reduced.

Availability of power and water: Area should be such which does not have a major problem of power and water, other wise the work gets badly effected, especially when the machines are to be run on motor.

Moreover power and water are very important as regards physical comfort of the workers better the conditions better will be the output. For emergencies some kind of arrangement needs to be planned so that the work does not get effected.

Availability of transport system: Transport is required for purchasing the raw material, for taking the orders and giving the supplies and for many such other things.

Availability of required skilled labour and prevailing wages: More skilled the labour more efficiently the business will run. Perfection and innovation is what is liked by every body, which only a skilled labour can do.

Space for future expansion: Every business starts on a small scale but slowly and gradually it expands so the planning needs to be done in such a way that there is always a scope for future expansion, more machines can be added, storage space is required for surplus which will be collected over the period of time and for many such other purposes.

❖ **Assessment for machinery and equipment**: The requirements for machinery, equipment's, spare parts, tools, etc. should be properly assessed depending upon the size of the unit. All the equipment and tools should be necessary ones and adequate. It is not necessary to buy all the equipment, but it is cheaper and convenient to hire some components or bought on job work basis from the market rather than making fresh investments. For selection of equipment's and machinery careful comparison of various brands - price, quality, warranty, sales services provided, delivery time and any other such points should be considered before the final purchase. Also buy from a known and authorized dealers, with proper bills and papers signed. Therefore a proper market survey is a very important exercise before final assessment and purchase of any machinery and equipment.

❖ Make **estimates of the money** or capital available with you.

- Calculate the amount of money you have for each head.
- If financing has to be done, then

- list out the financial institutions from where you can get loans.
- Or else you can also go to the banks.
- Decide upon the **means of financing,** is it long term / short term.

- **Arrangement of finances**: According to the size of the enterprise you can approach SIDBI/ banks/ Venture capital companies/ Commercial banks/ State capital corporations/ Small industrial development corporation/ Leasing companies/ Co-operative banks/ rural banks. State bank of India (SBI) offers various schemes to entrepreneurs to start their enterprises one such scheme is known as ***entrepreneur scheme***. Where it offers finances up to 2 lakhs, to the technically qualified experienced persons for setting up a unit. Rate of interest on such loans is also low. Always take financial help from government agencies and not from any private financiers. Government has lots of benefits and polices related to such kinds of loan as already mentioned, rate of interest is also low whereas with private financier you may at times get cheated and may not get any benefits. So be careful.

- **Raw material procurement**: As already said that the market for the procurement of the raw material should be near by. Also one should ensure that there is timely flow of raw materials. Buy the material from the whole sale market and make a trip when lots of material has to be purchased so that you save on the trips made on going to the market every time. A good market survey is also required for finally deciding upon the shops from where the material has to be purchased. One should work out various sources of supply of raw material and never depend upon on single source of procurement.

- **Marketing**: Marketing is the main and important area in making any enterprise successful. Though it is a complex process of creating customers for your product and services. Marketing involves knowing and reaching out to customers. The overall objective of marketing is to communicate your message create an awareness of your product or your services, motivate customers to buy and in effect it increases the sales of your product. Care should be taken regarding the following-

  - Budget for advertising
  - Method of promotion
  - Long term marketing

  The underline objective should be that your message should reach the people for which you can do advertising by

  - Posters
  - Pamphlets

- On Cable T V
- Word of mouth
- Exhibition & displays.

❖ Also see whether your enterprise requires to be registered or not. **Registration** is obtained from District Industry Centers (DIC). If it needs to be registered than all the formalities for registration have to be fulfilled.